EVERY DEVICE. ONE TOOL. PAY ONCE.

DOCUMENTATION — MODBUSMANAGER PRO V1.9.5 · STANDARD V1.4.10 · UPDATED 26 OCTOBER 2026

MODBUSMANAGER USER MANUAL

How to connect, poll, write, simulate, script, log, alarm, bridge and visualise Modbus data — and read Siemens S7 PLCs — with ModbusManager on Windows. Use the contents to jump to a topic, or download the whole manual as a printable PDF.

Free 14-day trial • Standard $49 • Pro $119 • Runtime $39 per machine • one-time licences • Windows 10 / 11

GETTING STARTED

ModbusManager is a Windows desktop tool for Modbus devices — PLCs, drives, energy meters, inverters and controllers. It polls and writes registers over Modbus TCP, RTU and ASCII, answers as a slave simulator, and in the Pro edition adds tags with Structured Text, a drag-and-drop HMI dashboard, a Historian, alarms, a gateway and Siemens S7 access. Everything runs locally; no cloud account is needed.

EDITIONS

EDITION	WHAT IT INCLUDES
Standard — $49	Connecting (all modes), poll windows and the register table, Write, Chart, Serial Monitor, Test Center, Slave Scan, Address Scan, the slave simulator, workspaces. Sections marked STD + PRO apply to it.
Pro — $119	Everything in Standard, plus Dashboard, Tags & Structured Text, History, Alarms, Gateway, Siemens S7 (beta), Runtime packages, device templates, Auto-detect, Diagnose, register snapshots and the PDF commissioning report. Marked PRO.
Runtime — $39 / machine	Runs a dashboard package made in Pro full screen on an OEM or panel PC, with no editor. See Runtime edition.

INSTALL 1

RUN THE INSTALLER

Download the installer and start ModbusManager from the Start menu.

TRIAL 2

14 DAYS, FULL FEATURES

The licence button in the toolbar shows the days left, e.g. “Trial: 12d”.

CONNECT

ADD YOUR DEVICE

Press **Connect** (or F3), choose the mode, enter the parameters.

BUILD

POLL & VISUALISE

Read registers, name them as tags, then build an operator screen.

On the first start Pro asks **“What would you like to do?”** — *Read a device*, *Simulate a slave*, *Combine several devices*, *Build a dashboard* or *Just let me look around* — and opens the matching tab. During the trial a short licence reminder appears at start and every 15 minutes; it also asks whether you managed to connect, and *I am stuck* leads to tips and a diagnostic text you can copy into a support e-mail.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

GUIDE

HMI DASHBOARD

Build a live operator screen without SCADA licences.

GUIDE

SIEMENS S7 PUT/GET

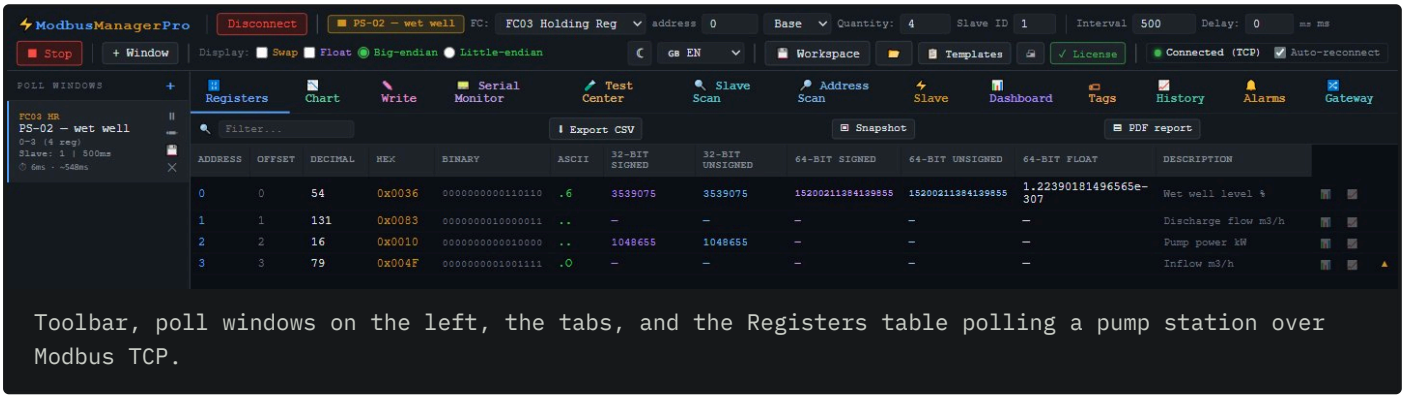
Read and write an S7-1200/1500 with no PLC code.

PDF

FULL MANUAL

This manual as a printable PDF.

THE MAIN WINDOW



Toolbar, poll windows on the left, the tabs, and the Registers table polling a pump station over Modbus TCP.

TOOLBAR

- **Connect / Disconnect** opens the connection dialog (`F3`).
- The amber badge names the selected **poll window**. **FC**, **address**, **Base 0 / Base 1**, **Quantity**, **Slave ID** and **Interval** belong to that window. **Delay** is a global pause between successive requests.
- **▶ Start / ■ Stop** starts and stops polling; **+ Window** adds a poll window (`Ctrl` + `M`).
- **Display: Swap**, **Float**, **Big-endian / Little-endian** change how 32-bit values are shown in the table.
- The moon/sun button switches the dark and light theme; the flag selects the language.
- **Workspace** (save) and the folder button (open), **Templates** `PRO`, Print, and **License**, which also shows the licence state: “Trial: 12d”, “✓ License” or “License expired”.
- On the right: the connection state and the **Auto-reconnect** switch.

POLL WINDOWS

Each poll window is one block of registers (function code, start, quantity, slave ID, interval). Every enabled window is polled in the background, whichever one is selected — so one meter's voltages and another device's status can be read side by side. In the list each window has pause/resume, edit (✎), save to the **Saved** list, and remove (✕).

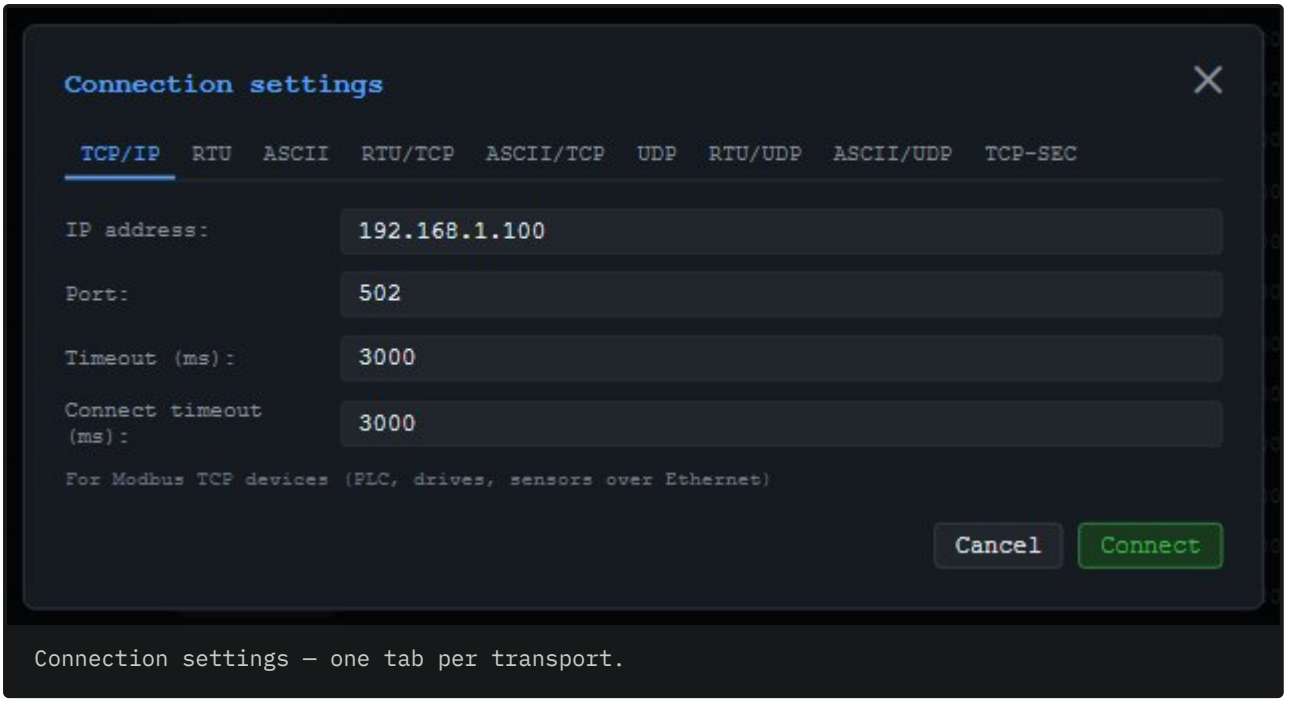
TABS

Registers, Chart, Write, Serial Monitor, Test Center, Slave Scan, Address Scan, Slave `STD + PRO` · **Dashboard, Tags, History, Alarms, Gateway** `PRO`.

LOG, STATUS BAR, TRAY

The **TX/RX log** under the tabs shows every request and reply (Stop pauses it, Clear empties it). The status bar counts TX, RX and **Errors**, shows the **Latency** and the device address, and has the 🔍 **Diagnose** link `PRO`. The tray icon menu offers *Keep running when window is closed* and *Start with Windows* — used by the gateway and alarms when they must run without a window. **Help → User manual** opens this page.

CONNECTING STD + PRO



Connection settings — one tab per transport.

MODE	USE IT FOR
TCP/IP	Modbus TCP devices on Ethernet. Fields: IP address, Port (502), Timeout, Connect timeout.
RTU	Serial RS-485 / RS-232 through a COM port or USB adapter.
ASCII	Serial Modbus ASCII (each byte as two hex characters). Port, baud (up to 19200) and parity.
RTU/TCP	RTU frames through a TCP socket — serial-to-Ethernet converters in transparent mode.
ASCII/TCP	Modbus ASCII frames (`:` + hex + LRC) through a TCP socket — converters that pass ASCII through.
UDP	Modbus UDP (the TCP header, in datagrams).
RTU/UDP	RTU frames with their CRC in UDP datagrams.
ASCII/UDP	Modbus ASCII frames in UDP datagrams.
TCP-SEC	Modbus/TCP Security: Modbus TCP inside TLS 1.2 or newer, port 802, with a client certificate — see below.

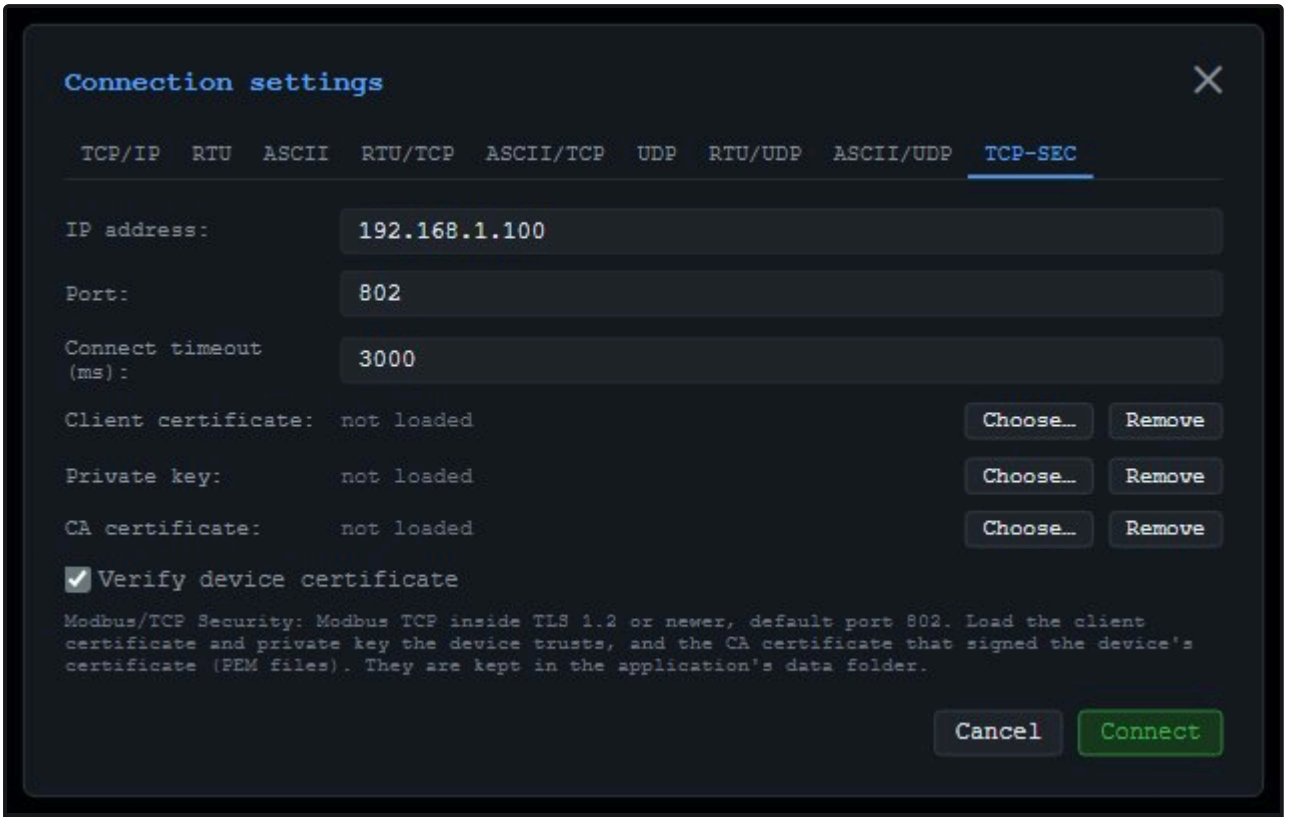
MODBUS TCP

1. Press **Connect**, stay on **TCP/IP**.
2. Enter the IP address and port (usually 502) and press **Connect**.
3. Set the **Slave ID** (unit ID) of the poll window — often 1, sometimes 0 or 255 for a direct TCP device; a gateway uses the ID of the serial device behind it.

MODBUS RTU

1. Plug in the USB-RS485 adapter and open **Connect** → **RTU**. Pick the **Serial port** (↻ refreshes the list).
2. Match the device: **Baud rate** (1200–115200, default 19200), **Parity**, **Data bits**, **Stop bits**. **Custom baud** overrides the list.
3. **RTS Toggle** raises RTS while sending, for RS-485 adapters that switch direction on RTS. Leave it off for adapters with automatic direction control (most USB adapters).
4. **Remove Echo** is for adapters that echo what they send: the echo of the request is dropped before the reply. Leave it off otherwise — on an adapter without echo, single writes (FC05/FC06), whose reply equals the request, would time out.

MODBUS/TCP SECURITY (TCP-SEC)



TCP-SEC: the certificate files and the device check.

1. Open **Connect** → **TCP-SEC**, enter the IP address and port (802).
2. **Client certificate** and **Private key**: the PEM files the device trusts (issued by the device's or your own certificate authority). **Choose…** loads a file once; it is kept in the application's data folder, not in the dialog.
3. **CA certificate**: the certificate that signed the device's certificate. With **Verify device certificate** ticked, a device whose certificate it did not sign is refused — untick it only for a test device with a self-signed certificate.

4. **Connect**. The log names the TLS version; a refusal says why (untrusted device, wrong name, expired, or the device rejected the client certificate).

> NOTE — AUTO-RECONNECT
> With **Auto-reconnect** ticked, a dropped connection is retried up to 10 times with growing pauses (2 s up to 15 s); the log shows “Auto-reconnect attempt n/10”.

> TIP
> Unknown baud rate or slave ID? Use Auto-detect PRO in the Slave Scan tab.

POLL WINDOWS & REGISTERS STD + PRO

FC	READS	TYPE
FC01	Coil Status	Read/write bits
FC02	Input Status	Read-only bits
FC03	Holding Registers	Read/write 16-bit words
FC04	Input Registers	Read-only 16-bit words

- **New poll window** (+ Window or `Ctrl`+`M`): Name, Function, Start address, Quantity (max 125), Slave ID, Interval (ms). In Pro, ↑ **Import CSV** loads a register map with descriptions.
- **Base 0 / Base 1**: Base 0 is protocol addressing (first register = 0), Base 1 documentation addressing (first register = 1). Choose what your device manual uses. A “40001”-style manual usually means Base 1 with FC03.
- **Interval** is per window; **Delay** is a global gap between requests, useful for slow serial devices.

THE REGISTER TABLE

Every value is shown at once as **Decimal, Hex, Binary, ASCII, 32-bit signed/unsigned, 64-bit signed/unsigned and 64-bit float**, plus a **Description**. A value that changed since the last poll is marked ▲.

- **Double-click a value** to write it (FC06/FC05/FC16) — see Writing. **Double-click the description** to name the register.
- **Right-click**: *Copy value*, *Write value*, *Value Names* (show 0 as “Off”, 1 as “Run”…), *Conditional Colors* (colour a cell by a rule). On a 32-bit cell, right-click picks the **word order**: big-endian, word-swapped, byte-swapped or fully reversed.

- Row buttons: 📊 *Add to Dashboard* and 📈 *Log to History* PRO.
- **Filter…** narrows the rows; **⬇ Export CSV** saves the active window or all windows.
- PRO **Snapshot** stores a baseline and highlights what changed since (**Clear diff** ends it); **PDF report** prints a Modbus commissioning report of the windows.

> SCALING
> In **Pro** the register table always shows the raw value the device sent. Engineering units belong to tags (Scale and Offset) and to History series, so one register can be scaled once and used everywhere. In **Standard**, right-click → **Scaling** multiplies and offsets the value in the table.

WRITING VALUES STD + PRO

The **Write** tab sends any write function: **FC05** single coil, **FC06** single register, **FC16** multiple registers, **FC22** mask write and **FC23** read/write multiple. Choose the **Format** (16-bit, 32-bit signed/unsigned/float, 64-bit signed/unsigned/float) and the tool splits the value into registers in the word order you selected. Enter the register address, value (or comma-separated values) and slave ID, then **Send command** →. The reply or the exception is reported at once.

For a quick change, double-click a value in the register table: the **Write Register** dialog opens with the address filled in.

> WARNING
> A write changes the controller. Check the slave ID, the address base and the value before sending — especially on running machinery.

CHART, SERIAL MONITOR & TEST CENTER STD + PRO

- **Chart**: up to three charts, each one register with its slave, format, name and Y range. **Cursor** reads values off the line, and **Log** records the series to a file you can download.
- **Serial Monitor**: the raw bytes on the connection, as HEX or ASCII with timestamps; **Download** saves the capture.

- **Test Center**: compose one request by hand — FC01–06, 15, 16, 22, 23, 08 (diagnostics, with sub-codes), 11 (comm event counter), 17 (report server ID) and 43/14 (device identification) — and inspect the exact reply. A history keeps the last requests.

SCANNING & DIAGNOSTICS

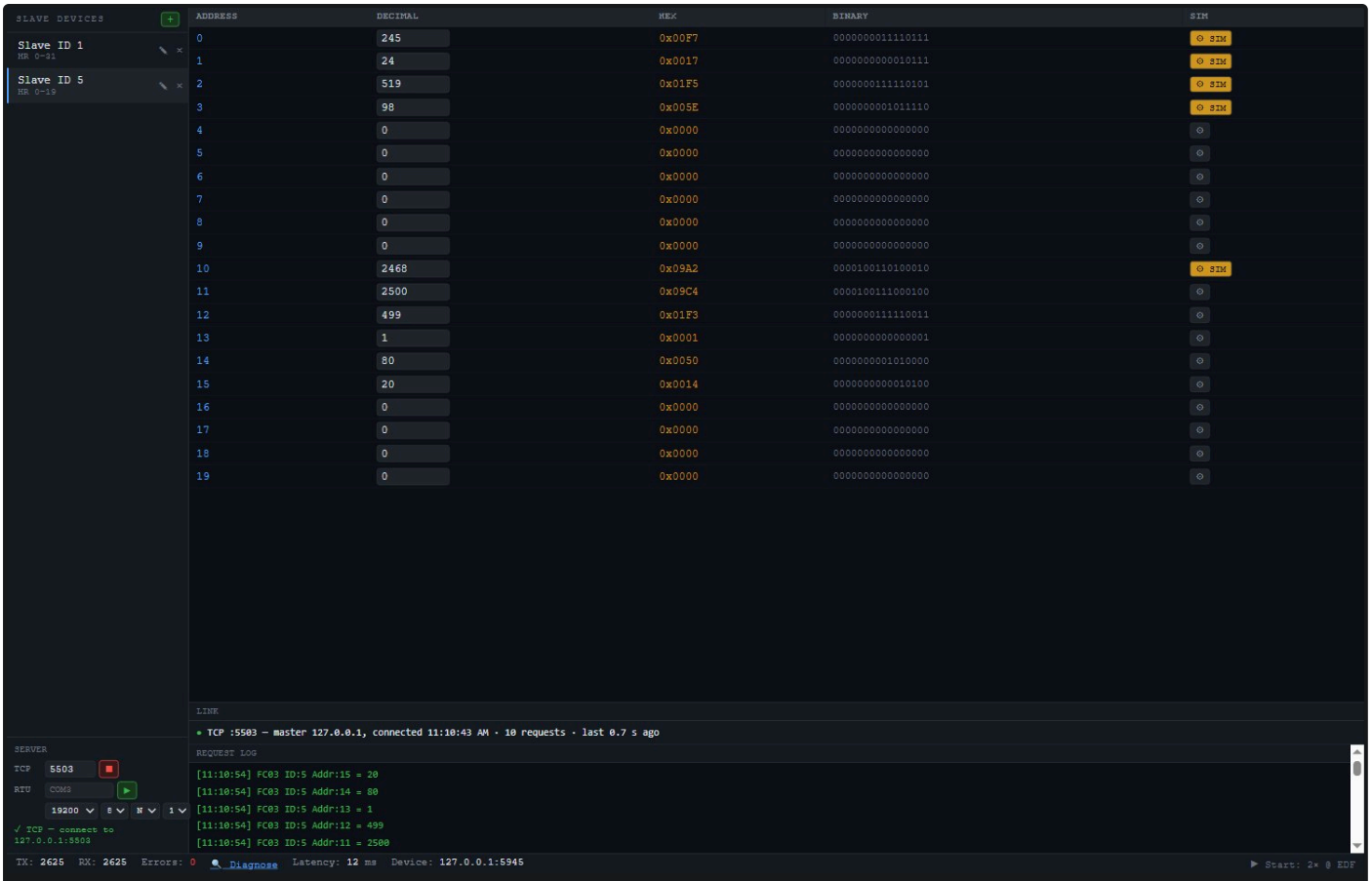
Slave Scan `STD + PRO` probes a range of slave IDs (From ID / To ID) with one read and lists who answers — for a device on the bus whose address is unknown. **Address Scan** sweeps a register range on one slave in blocks and lists which addresses return data — for mapping an undocumented device; the result exports to CSV.

⚡ **Auto-detect** `PRO`, in the Slave Scan tab, tries baud rates, parity settings and slave IDs on a COM port (or unit IDs behind a TCP gateway) until a device answers, then **Use these settings** applies them.

🔍 **Diagnose** `PRO`, in the status bar, reads the recent error history and says what kind of failure it is: no reply, timeouts now and then, a Modbus exception, refused or reset TCP, garbled frames, port not found or port busy — with what to check for each.

SLAVE SIMULATOR `STD + PRO`

The **Slave** tab makes ModbusManager a Modbus server that answers like real hardware: for testing a SCADA, HMI or PLC program before the device exists, for training, or as the far end of the gateway.



Slave ID 5 with four simulated registers and a PID process at 10–15; the Link panel shows the master that is reading it.

1. **+** under **Slave devices** adds a block: Slave ID, Register type (Holding, Input, Coils, Discrete Inputs), Start address, Quantity (up to 1000). A slave ID can have several blocks; overlapping blocks are refused.
2. Under **Server** start **TCP** on a port (502 by default) and/or **RTU** on a COM port. The RTU line has its own baud, data bits, parity and stop bits — independent of the Connect dialog, so the same PC can be master on one port and slave on another.
3. Type a value straight into the **Decimal** column, or press the ⚙ button for a simulation.



A sine wave between 200 and 260 with a one-minute period.

Simulation types: **Static value** PRO, **Counter ↑**, **Counter ↓**, **Sine wave**, **Random**, **Ramp** and **PID loop (simulated process)**, each as UInt16, Int16, Int32, UInt32 or Float32 with a word order. Keep the simulation interval well below the master's poll interval, and a sine period at least ten times the poll interval, or the master sees repeated or skipped values.

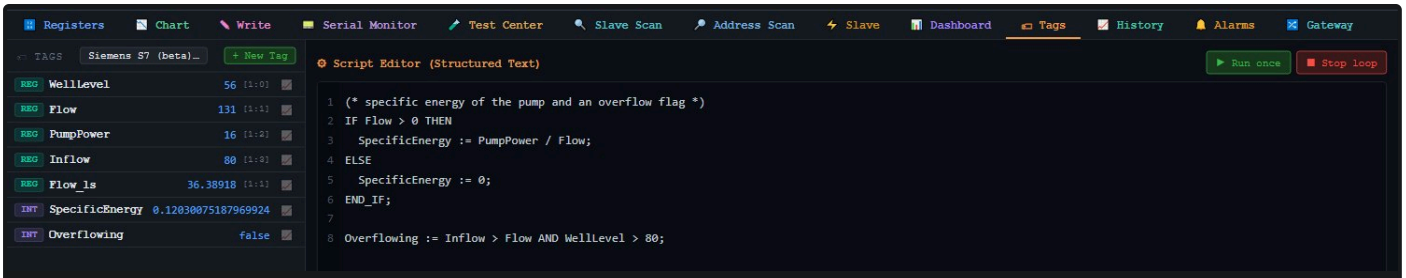
The **PID loop** uses six holding registers: +0 process value ×10, +1 setpoint ×10, +2 output 0–1000, +3 mode (1 = auto), +4 P ×10, +5 I in seconds. A master — or the dashboard's PID faceplate — can change the setpoint and watch the process follow.

LINK PANEL

The **Link** line tells you whether a master is really there: “TCP :502 — master 192.168.0.10, connected … requests · last 0.7 s ago”, the RTU request rate and bad-CRC frames (wrong baud or parity), requests for a unit ID this slave does not have, and refused requests with the reason in the **Request log** below.

TAGS & STRUCTURED TEXT PRO

A tag gives a value a name, so dashboards, alarms, the Historian, the gateway and scripts can use `WellLevel` instead of “slave 1, FC03, address 0”.



Register tags (REG), a scaled tag (Flow_ls) and internal tags (INT) computed by a Structured Text loop.

TYPE	DESCRIPTION
Register (REG)	A Modbus value: Slave ID, Reg Type, Address, Data type (Int16, UInt16, Int32, UInt32, Float32), Word order (High word first / Low word first), **Scale** × and **Offset** +.
Internal (INT)	A value that lives in the application, usually set by a script.
Siemens S7 (S7) BETA	A value in an S7 PLC: PLC, area (DB, M, I, Q), DB number, byte, bit and type. See Siemens S7.



A 32-bit energy counter in 0.1 kWh counts, shown in kWh: Scale 0.1.

Scale and offset: value = raw × scale + offset. A write to a scaled tag (from the dashboard, a script or the gateway) is converted back to the raw register value. Names start with a letter and contain letters, digits and _; they are not case-sensitive in scripts. Renaming a tag carries its dashboard bindings, alarms and history with it; deleting one tells you first where it is used.

> NOTE — WHERE VALUES COME FROM
>
> A register tag gets its value from polling: its address must be inside a running poll window or bound to a dashboard element, and polling (▶ Start) must run.

STRUCTURED TEXT

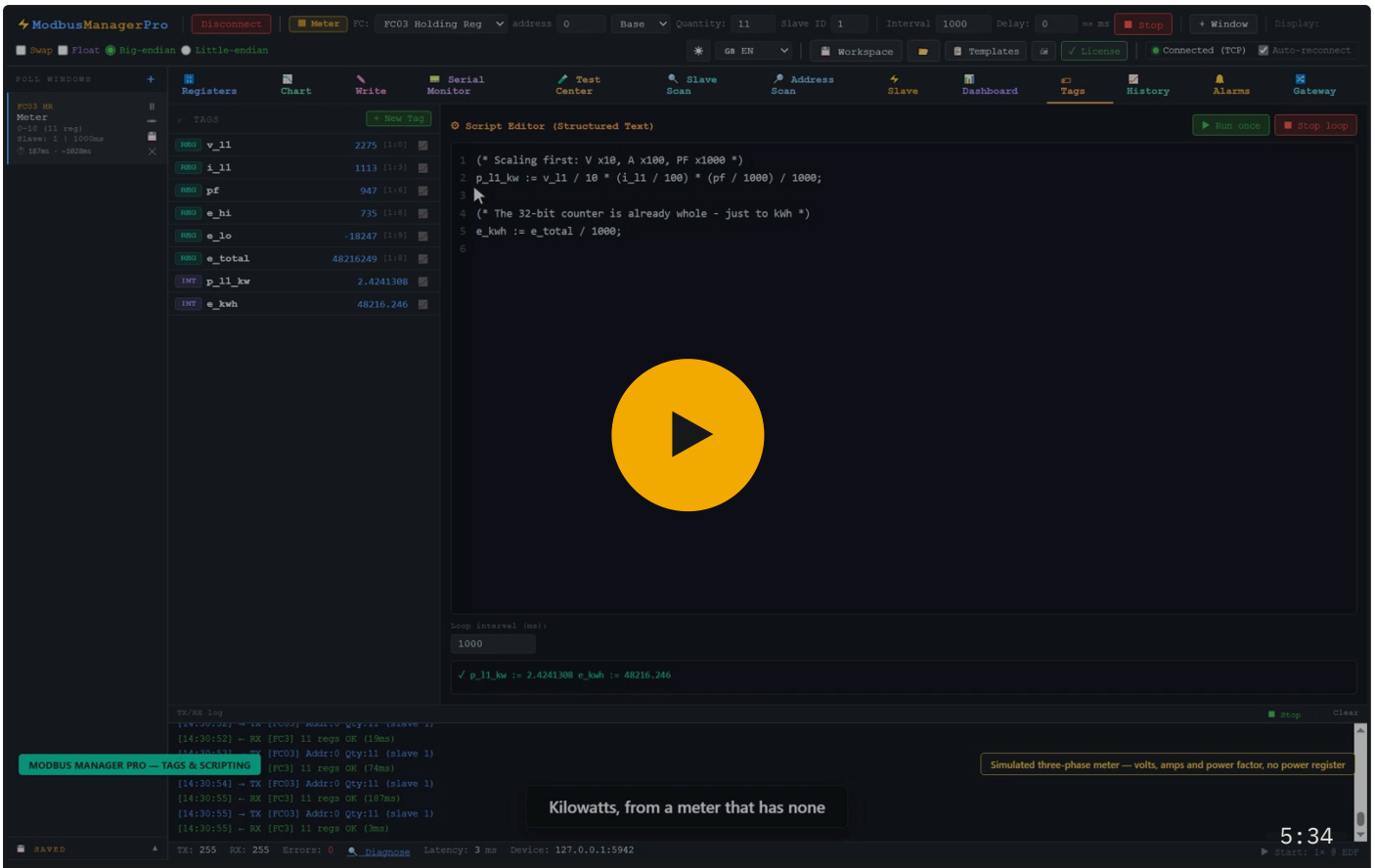
The **Script Editor (Structured Text)** runs IEC 61131-3 style code against the tags. ▶ **Run once** tests it; ▶ **Start loop** runs it every **Loop interval** (minimum 100 ms). The output box shows each assignment or the error with its line number. A run is stopped after 2 s, and the loop stops after five errors in a row.

```
(* specific energy of the pump and an overflow flag *)
IF Flow > 0 THEN
  SpecificEnergy := PumpPower / Flow;
ELSE
  SpecificEnergy := 0;
```

```
  END_IF;

  Overflowing := Inflow > Flow AND WellLevel > 80;
```

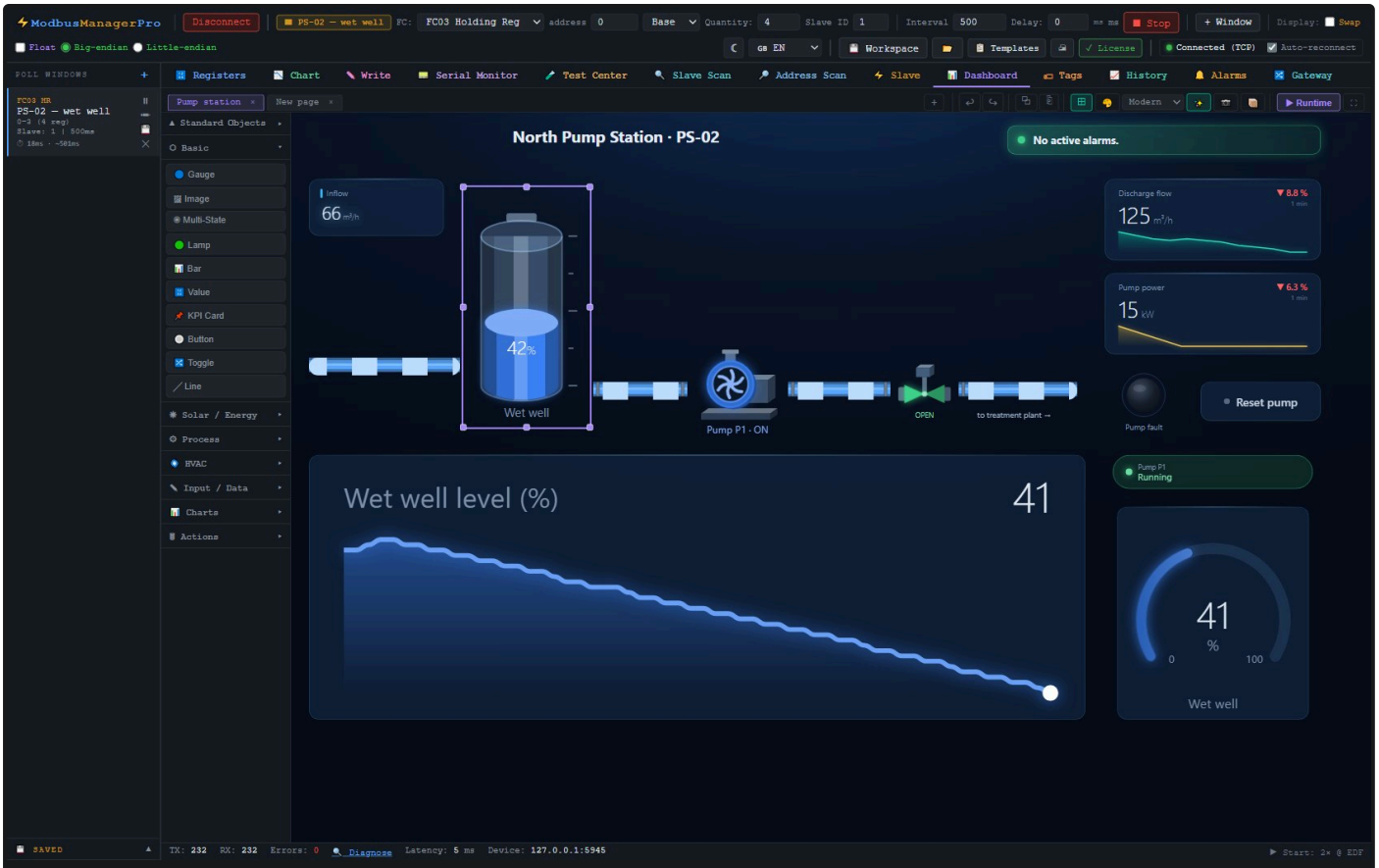
Supported: `:=`, `+ - * /`, comparisons `= <> < > <= >=`, `AND OR NOT`, `TRUE FALSE`, `IF … ELSIF … ELSE … END_IF`, `FOR i := 1 TO n DO … END_FOR` and comments `(* *)`. `WHILE`, `REPEAT`, `CASE` and the standard function blocks (timers, `LIMIT`…) are not available.



Naming registers, a 32-bit energy counter read as one number, and a Structured Text loop producing kilowatts from a meter that reports none.

HMI DASHBOARD PRO

The **Dashboard** is a drag-and-drop canvas for operator screens. Pick an element from the palette, place it, bind it to a register, tag or S7 address in the **Properties** panel, then press ▶ **Runtime** to operate it.



Edit mode, Modern theme: palette on the left, page tabs and toolbar on top, the selected tank outlined.

PAGES AND TOOLBAR

- **Pages**: + adds one; double-click a tab for **Page settings** — name, size, and **Popup page** (hidden from the tabs, opened by clicking an element whose *Open popup* points to it). The tab's × deletes a page after asking; `Ctrl`+`Z` brings it back.
- **Undo / Redo** (`Ctrl`+`Z` / `Ctrl`+`Y`), **Copy / Paste** (`Ctrl`+`C` / `V`), snap to grid, background colour.
- **Theme**: **Classic** (flat) or **Modern** (cards, 3D equipment, glow). The theme changes only the look — no binding or setting of any element changes. In Modern, ✨ switches the glow and moving-value effects.
- 📷 exports the page as PNG; 📦 makes a Runtime package; ⛶ goes full screen (Esc leaves).
- Drag a frame to select several elements; arrow keys nudge; the **Actions** group aligns, locks, deletes and clears the page.

ELEMENTS

GROUP	ELEMENTS
Standard Objects	Rectangle, Rounded Rect, Circle, Ellipse, Polygon, Polyline, Circular Arc, Ellipse Arc, Pie Segment, Ellipse Segment, Static Text, Connector
Basic	Gauge, Image, Multi-State, Lamp, Bar, Value, KPI Card, Button, Toggle, Line

GROUP	ELEMENTS
Solar / Energy	Semi Gauge, Battery, Trend, Flow Arrow, Icon + Value, Progress Bar, Status Badge
Process	Tank, Motor, Valve, Pump, Pipe, Silo, Conveyor
HVAC	Fan, Boiler, Damper, Heating Coil, Cooling Coil, Filter, Compressor, AHU, Thermostat, Humidifier, Heat Exchanger
Input / Data	Slider, Enum Write, Setpoint, PID Loop, Clock
Charts	Bar Graph, Value Table, Multi Trend, Alarm List, Alarm Banner

PROPERTIES AND BINDING

Select an element to open **Properties**. **Source** is **Register** (slave ID, register type, address — polled in the background while polling runs, even without a poll window), **Tag**, or **Siemens S7 (beta)**. The other fields follow the element: label, min/max, unit, decimals, font size, compare and threshold, on/off colours and labels, states (`0=Off:#8892a4,1=On:#00d4aa`), options for Enum Write, write value for a Button, flow and spin direction, image file, size, layer order. In the Modern theme a **Style (Modern)** block adds main and second colour, alarm and warning levels, arc span, glow and glass card. A **KPI Card** shows the change over a period, in per cent or in units.

TRENDS AND CHANNEL CHARTS

- **Trend**: one value over time. **Max points** sets the length, **Sample interval (ms)** how often a point is taken (default 1000 ms; never faster than the value actually arrives). A steady value keeps drawing.
- **Bar Graph, Value Table, Multi Trend, Alarm List** hold several channels: 📋 **Edit channels…** sets each channel's source (register or tag), name, unit, colour and, for Multi Trend and Value Table, **Visible when** (show the channel only while a tag is non-zero).
- **Multi Trend** adds max points, sample interval, **Scroll back (min)** up to 24 h, decimals, Y range and legend position. In Runtime it has pause, zoom on X and Y, a time-window dialog and a scroll-back slider.
- **Alarm List** uses manual thresholds or the alarm system; with the alarm system it, and the **Alarm Banner**, offer ✓ **Ack all**.

PID LOOP FACEPLATE

The **PID Loop** element shows a controller: PV, setpoint, output bar, a small trend, auto/manual and the P, I and D values. Each role — Process value, Setpoint, Output, Auto/Manual, Manual output, P, I, D — is bound to a register or a tag, with a raw-divisor for PV/SP and for the output (e.g. 10 when the register holds ×10). In Runtime the operator can change the setpoint, switch auto/manual and set the manual output, each after a confirmation. P, I and D are only displayed.



A PID faceplate and a Multi Trend bound to a loop in a Siemens S7 PLC.

RUNTIME MODE AND WRITES

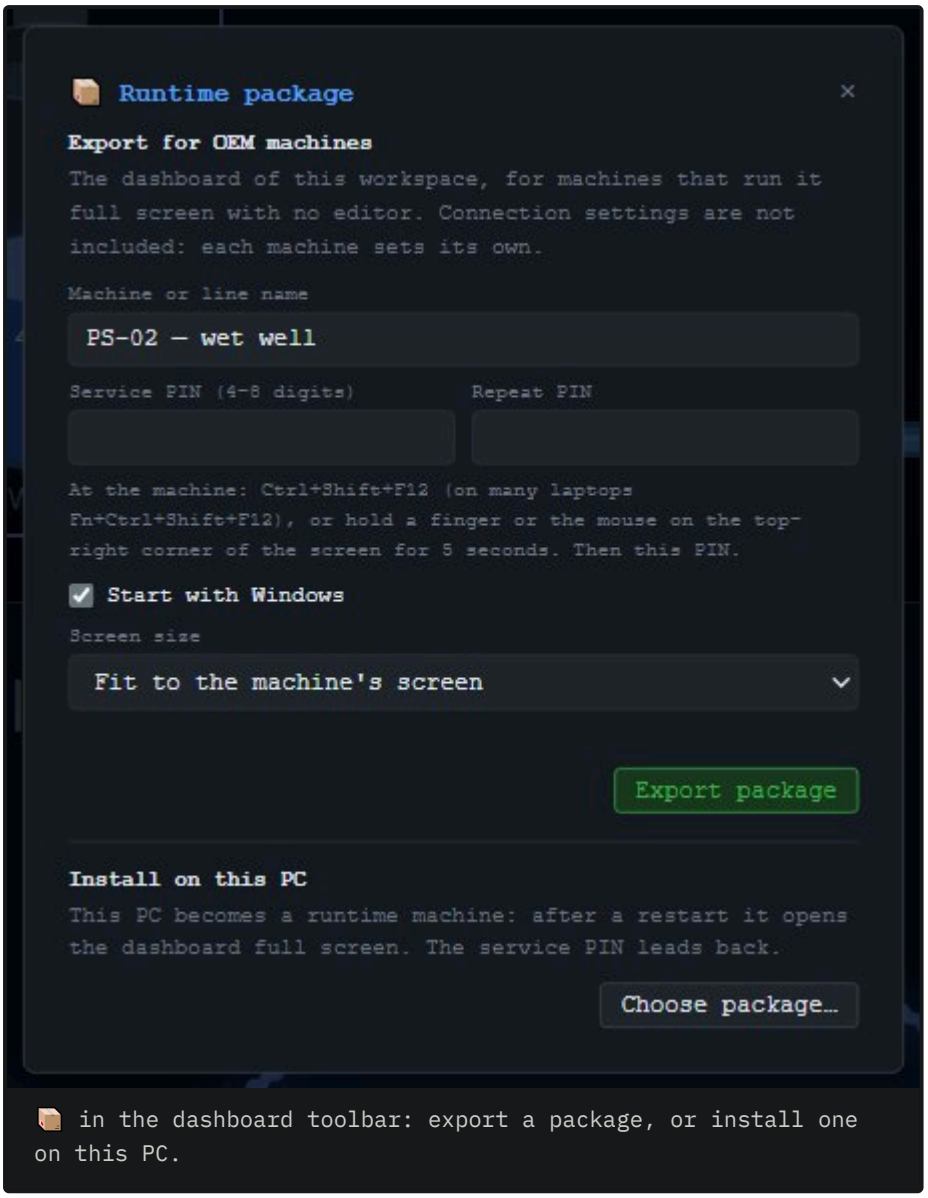


Runtime during a high-level alarm: the banner, the red tank and gauge, the stopped pump.

- Write elements (Button, Toggle, Slider, Setpoint, Enum Write, PID) write **only in Runtime**, and only after the element has read a value, so a click in edit mode or on an empty screen never sends anything.
- A value that stops arriving is dimmed and keeps its last reading; hover shows “Not current — last update …”. Text in a numeric field shows “—”.

RUNTIME EDITION PRO

A machine builder designs the screen once in Pro and installs it on every machine’s panel PC, where it runs full screen with no editor. See also the HMI Runtime page.



in the dashboard toolbar: export a package, or install one on this PC.

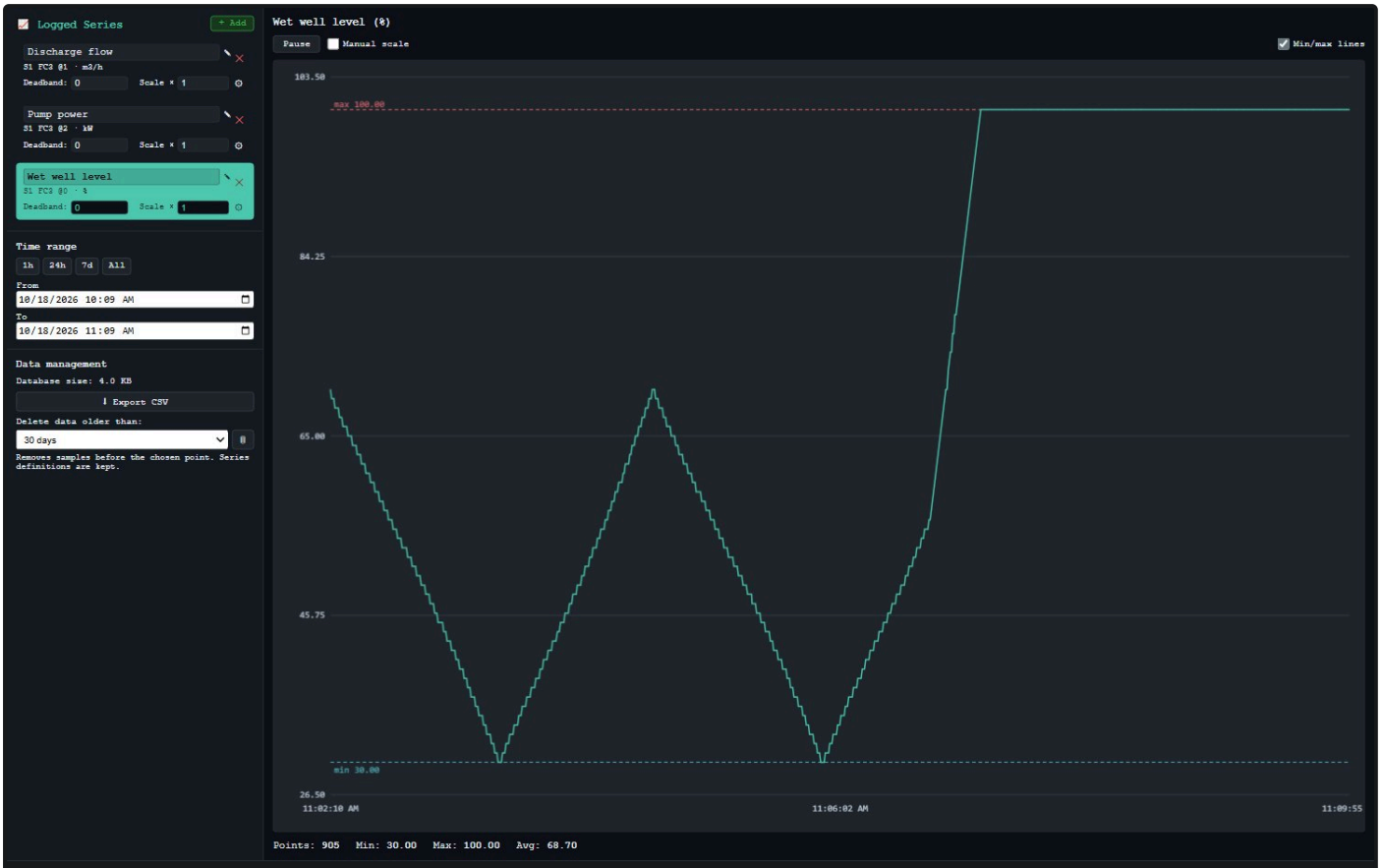
1. **Export**: name the machine or line, set a **Service PIN** (4–8 digits), choose *Start with Windows* and the screen size (*Fit to the machine’s screen* or *Actual size 1:1*), then **Export package**. A `.mmrt` file is written to Documents. It carries the dashboard, tags and script — not the connection settings and not the gateway.

2. **Install**: on the panel PC open 📦 → **Choose package…** and restart. The PC opens the dashboard full screen; on the first start it asks for this machine's connection (and S7 PLC addresses).
3. **Service**: press `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`F12` (on many laptops with `Fn`) or hold the top-right corner for 5 s, then the PIN. The Service menu has Connection settings, Siemens S7 PLCs, Install another package, Licence, Open the editor (only with a Pro licence or trial), Make this an ordinary PC, and Close the application. Five wrong PINs lock it for a minute.

Licensing: a Runtime key (`MBUSR-`, $39 per machine) runs packages without limit but never opens the editor. A PC with a Pro licence or trial runs them too. Without either, a package runs as a 2-hour demo: then polling stops and the Machine ID is shown with an Activate button; a restart gives another 2 hours.

HISTORY (HISTORIAN) PRO

The Historian stores values in a local database for days or months and charts any time range.



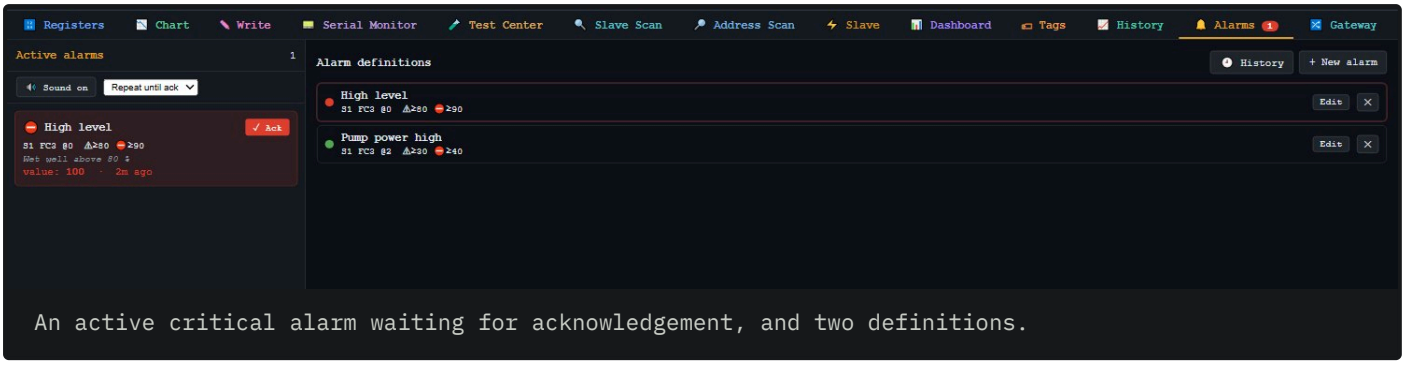
Logged series on the left, one hour of the wet well level on the right.

- **Start logging**: 📈 on a register row or a tag, or **+ Add** in **Logged Series** (name, register or tag, slave, function, address, data type, word order, unit). Recording starts at once.
- Samples arrive at the poll rate. **Deadband** stores a sample only when the value moved at least that much (0 = store all); writes to disk are batched every 5 s.

- **Scale** × and ⚙ **Display scale** (scale, offset, decimals, chart min/max) change how a series is shown; the database keeps the raw value, so a scale can be corrected later.
- **Time range**: 1h, 24h, 7d, All, or From/To. Drag on the chart to zoom, **Manual scale** fixes the Y axis, **Min/max lines** marks the extremes; the statistics show points, min, max and average.
- **Data management**: database size, ⬇ **Export CSV** of the selected series (ISO time, milliseconds, value), and **Delete data older than** 1 day … 1 year or a date. Series definitions are kept.

More on intervals and deadband: logging interval & deadband · CSV export.

ALARMS PRO



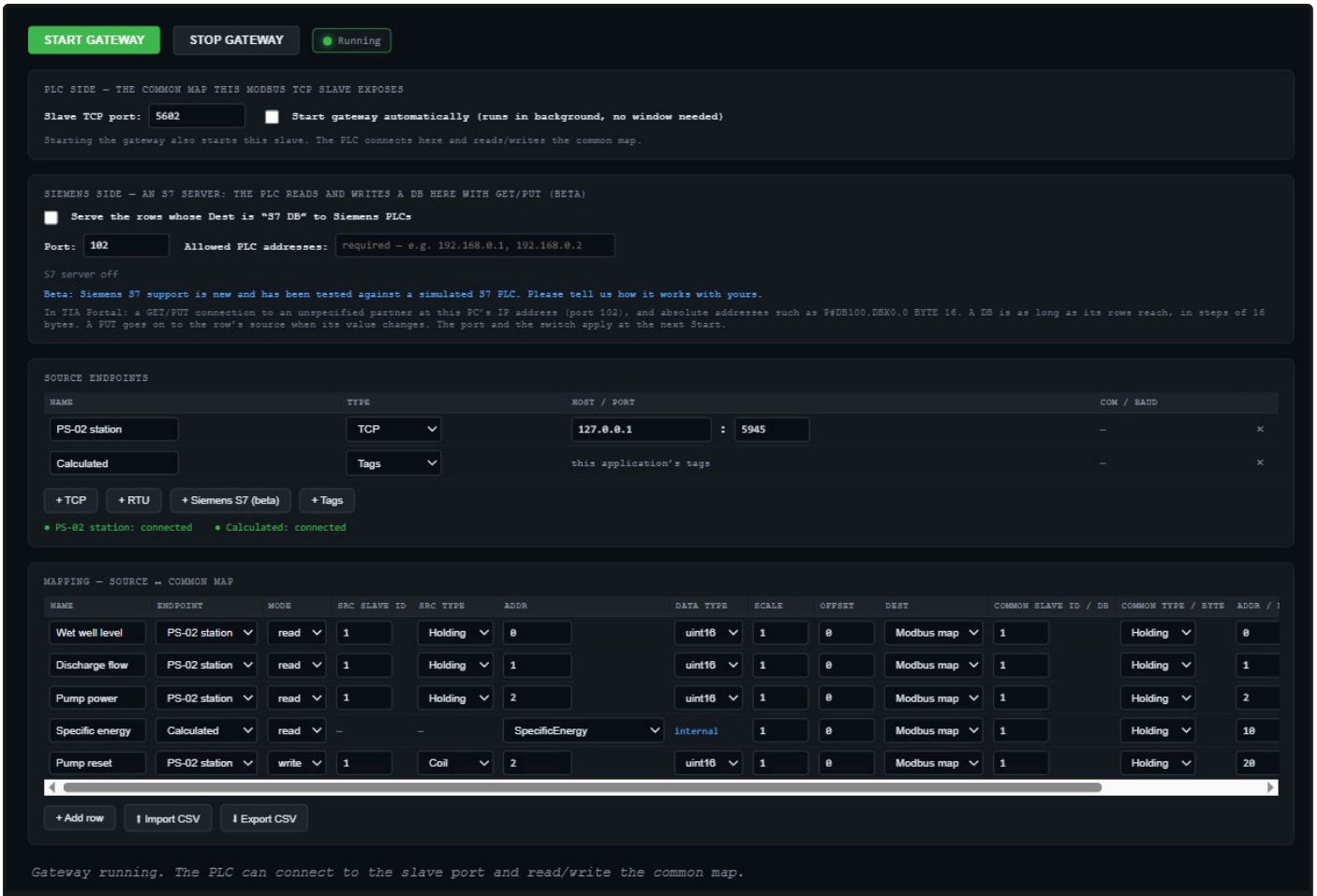
An active critical alarm waiting for acknowledgement, and two definitions.

- **+ New alarm**: name, description, source (register or tag) and condition: greater, less, greater or equal, less or equal, equal, not equal, between, outside range.
- Greater/less conditions have two optional levels, ⚠ **Warning limit** and ⛔ **Critical limit**; equal/not equal take a value; range conditions take lower and upper.
- **Hysteresis** keeps a value that hovers at the limit from raising and clearing the alarm repeatedly; **Delay (s)** raises it only after the condition has held that long.
- **Active alarms** lists what is raised; ✓ **Ack** acknowledges. **Sound on** / **Muted** and *Repeat until ack* / *Beep once* choose the alert. **History** lists raised, cleared and acknowledged times.
- On a dashboard, the **Alarm Banner** and an **Alarm List** in alarm-system mode show the same alarms and acknowledge them.

> NOTE
>
> Alarms are evaluated by the application while it runs — keep it running in the tray (*Keep running when window is closed*) for unattended monitoring. There are no e-mail or SMS notifications.

GATEWAY PRO

The gateway polls several devices as a master and republishes the values you choose as one **common Modbus TCP map** — or as a data block an S7 PLC reads with GET, or to an **MQTT** broker such as Home Assistant's — with type and scale conversion both ways. Writes from the PLC (or from Home Assistant) are forwarded to the device.



Two endpoints (a TCP device and this application's tags) mapped into one common register map.

1. **PLC side**: the **Slave TCP port** the PLC or SCADA connects to (502 by default).
2. **Source endpoints**: **+ TCP** (host, port), **+ RTU** (COM port, baud, parity), **+ Siemens S7 (beta)** (a PLC from the S7 list) and **+ Tags** (this application's tags, including script results).
3. **Mapping rows**: name, endpoint, mode (**read** device → map, or **write** map → device), source slave ID, type and address (an S7 address or a tag for those endpoints), data type, scale and offset, then the destination: **Modbus map** (common slave ID, type, address, data type), **S7 DB (beta)** (DB, byte, bit, S7 type) or **MQTT** (topic, unit, Home Assistant device class).
4. **Start gateway**. Each endpoint and row shows its state; a row with an error says why.

⬆ Import CSV and **⬇ Export CSV** move rows and endpoints to and from a spreadsheet. **Start gateway automatically** plus the tray options *Keep running when window is closed* and *Start with Windows* run it

unattended. The gateway configuration is saved with the workspace.

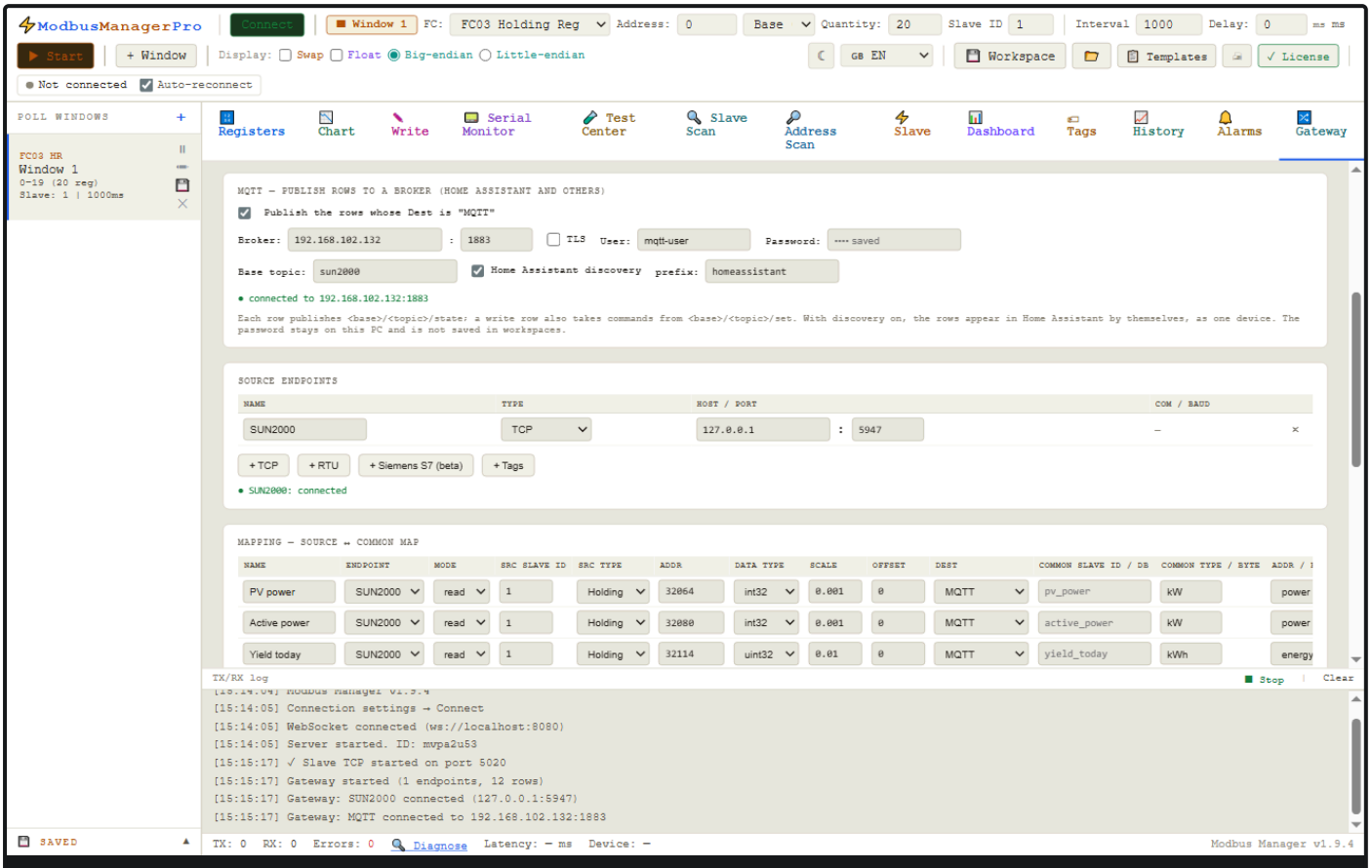
S7 SERVER: THE PLC READS A DB FROM MODBUSMANAGER BETA

With **Serve the rows whose Dest is "S7 DB" to Siemens PLCs** the gateway also answers as an S7 server (port 102): an S7-1200/1500 reads the rows with a **GET** block and writes them with **PUT** — no Modbus program in the PLC. In TIA Portal create a GET/PUT connection to an unspecified partner at this PC's IP address and use absolute addresses such as `P#DB100.DBX0.0 BYTE 16`. A DB is as long as its rows reach, in steps of 16 bytes; a PUT is forwarded to the row's source when its value changes.

> ALLOWED PLC ADDRESSES
>
> Only PLCs listed in **Allowed PLC addresses** (comma-separated IPs) can connect. An empty list refuses everyone, and the panel warns about it. The list applies at once; removing an address drops that PLC.

MQTT AND HOME ASSISTANT

A row with Dest **MQTT** publishes its value to an MQTT broker — Home Assistant's Mosquitto add-on or any other — as `<base topic>/<topic>/state`, retained. The row keeps its own source, scale and offset; only the destination differs, so a device can feed the common map, an S7 DB and MQTT at the same time from one connection.



The MQTT panel connected to Home Assistant, and rows with Dest MQTT.

1. In the **MQTT** panel tick **Publish the rows whose Dest is "MQTT"**, then set the **Broker** address and port (1883; 8883 with **TLS**), **User**, **Password** and the **Base topic**.
2. Set a row's **Dest** to **MQTT**. Its columns become the topic (empty: made from the name), the unit and the Home Assistant device class; the last column shows what the row becomes in Home Assistant.
3. **Start gateway**. The panel says *connected*, or why not: user name or password refused, no broker at this address, broker not reachable, certificate not trusted.

With **Home Assistant discovery** on, each MQTT row appears in Home Assistant by itself, all under one device, with its name, unit and device class: a value as a *sensor* (a coil or discrete input as a *binary sensor*), a write row as a *number* (a coil as a *switch*). Rows with device class *energy* are published as growing totals for the Energy dashboard. A write row also takes commands from `<base>/<topic>/set`: the value goes to the device and is read back. `<base>/status` says *online* or *offline*, so Home Assistant shows the entities as unavailable when the gateway stops or the PC drops off. A row deleted here is removed from Home Assistant too.

> THE PASSWORD STAYS ON THIS PC
> The broker password is stored apart from the gateway configuration and is never written to a workspace or a CSV export. A workspace moved to another PC asks for it again. Home Assistant's Mosquitto add-on accepts a Home Assistant user name and password.

Full example with a free workspace: Huawei SUN2000 to Home Assistant over Modbus and MQTT.

SIEMENS S7 (BETA) PRO

Pro reads and writes Siemens S7-1200, S7-1500 and S7-300/400 PLCs over S7 communication (PUT/GET) — data blocks, merkers, inputs and outputs — with no communication block in the PLC program. It is released as **beta**: tested against a simulated S7 PLC; feedback from real CPUs is welcome.

1. In TIA Portal: CPU properties → Protection & Security → *Permit access with PUT/GET communication*; for every DB you read, turn off *Optimized block access*; download.
2. In ModbusManager: Tags → **Siemens S7 (beta)…** (also in the gateway, the dashboard source and the Runtime service menu) → **+ Add PLC**: ID, name, IP address, port 102, rack 0 and slot 1 for S7-1200/1500 (slot 2 for S7-300/400), poll interval. **Test read** checks an address.
3. Create S7 tags, bind dashboard elements to **Siemens S7**, or add an S7 endpoint to the gateway.

Address syntax: `DB1,REAL4` · `DB1,INT2` · `DB1,X12.0` (bit) · `MW2` · `M0.0` · `IW64`. Writes are converted to the address type (a bit takes 0/1, integers are rounded, REAL keeps decimals). The PLC's

state shows as online, connecting, error, or idle when nothing reads from it. The PLC ID ties tags to the PLC, so a runtime package keeps working when each machine's PLC has a different IP.

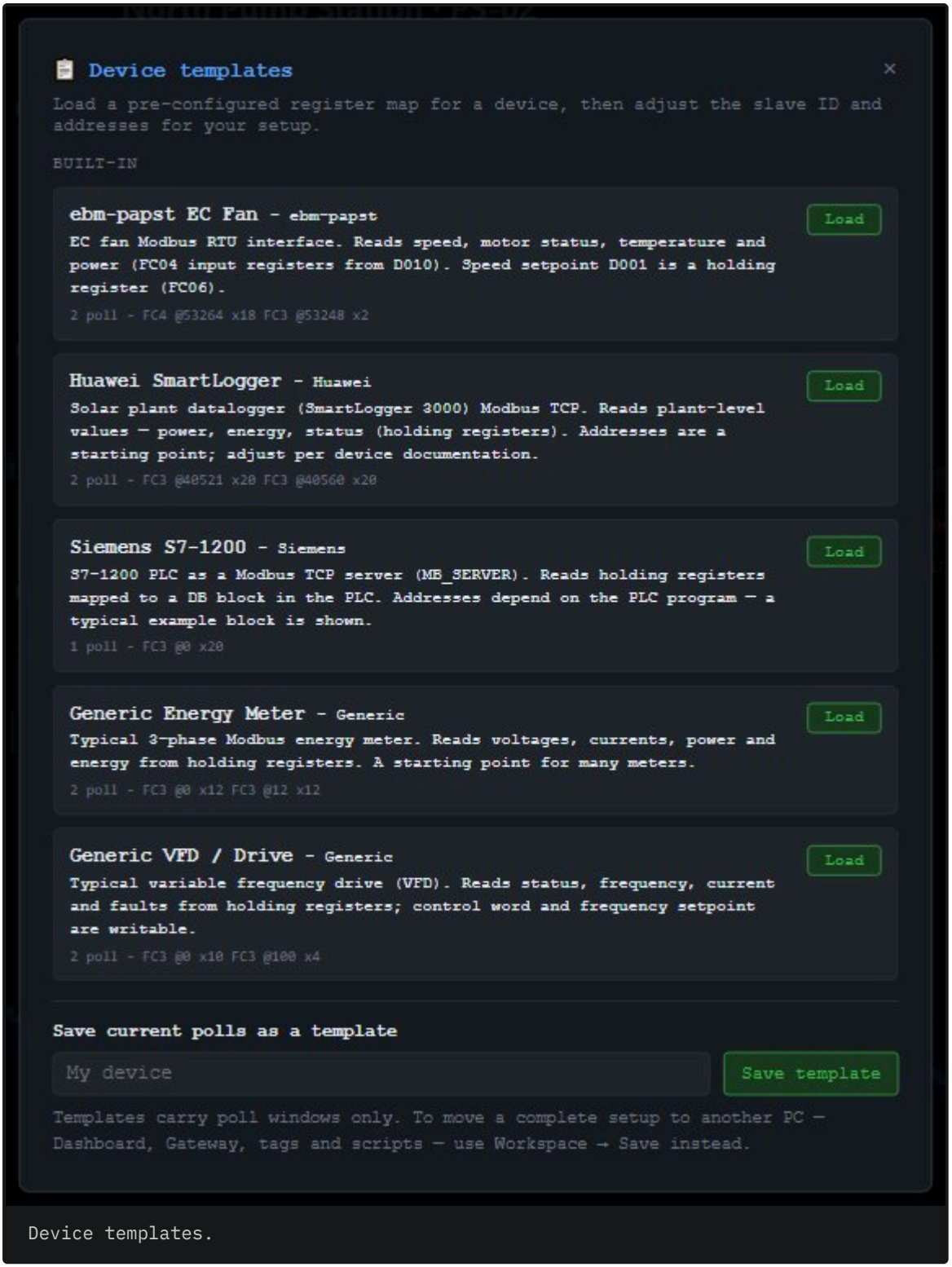
Full guide: Siemens S7-1200 / S7-1500 PUT/GET from a PC.

WORKSPACES & TEMPLATES

A **workspace** STD + PRO is one JSON file with your setup. 💾 **Workspace** saves it to Documents; the folder button opens one from the list or by **Browse…**. On quit the application asks whether to save.

SAVED IN THE WORKSPACE	NOT IN THE WORKSPACE
Poll windows and their descriptions, Value Names, conditional colours, chart series, slave blocks; in Pro also the dashboard (pages, theme, effects, background), tags, the script and its interval, which series the Historian logs, and the gateway configuration (opening asks before applying it).	Connection settings (each PC keeps its own), alarm definitions and the S7 PLC list (kept by the application), simulations on slave registers, and recorded history.

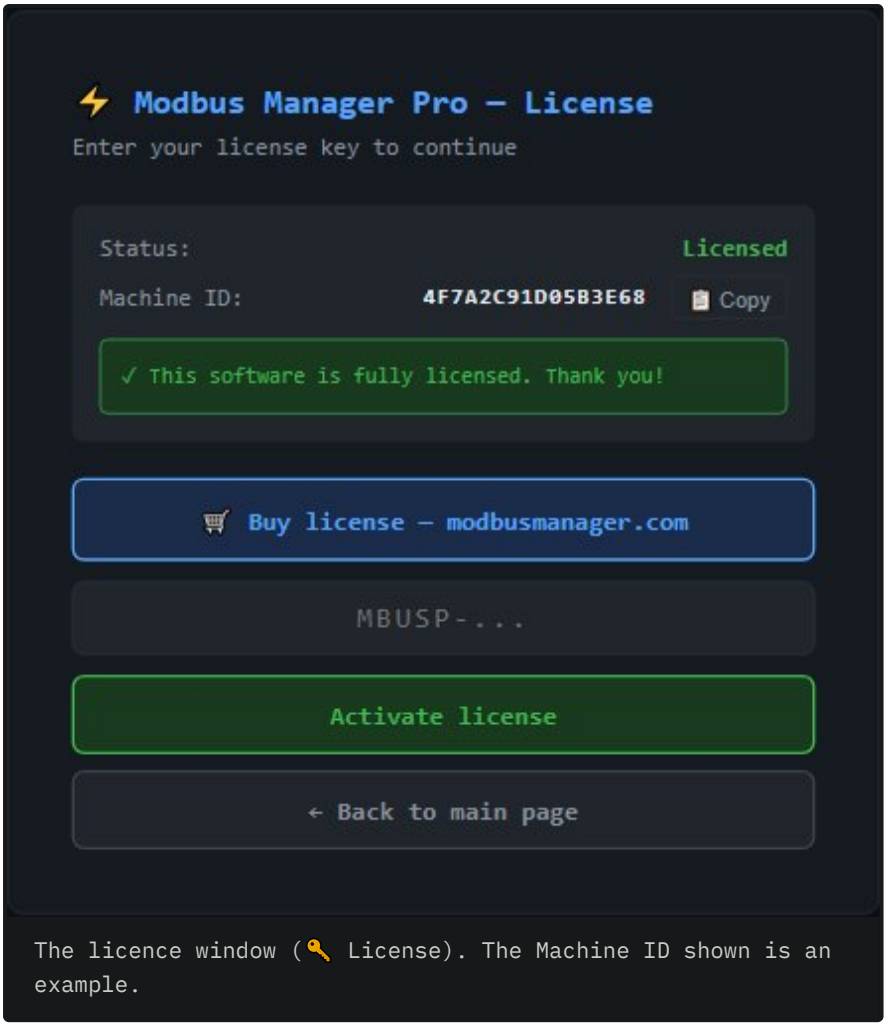
Device templates PRO load ready poll windows for a device — ebm-papst EC fan, Huawei SmartLogger, Siemens S7-1200 (as Modbus TCP server), a generic energy meter and a generic VFD — and **Save template** stores your own. Templates carry poll windows only; use a workspace to move a complete setup.



Device templates.

Ready workspaces for many devices are on the device guide pages (Guides menu), e.g. Eastron SDM630 or Huawei SUN2000.

LICENSING



The licence window (🔧 License). The Machine ID shown is an example.

- **Trial**: 14 days with every feature, from the first start. Reinstalling does not reset it. When it ends, the licence window opens instead of the application until a key is activated.
- **Machine ID**: shown in the licence window, with a copy button. A key is issued for that ID: buy on modbusmanager.com, enter the Machine ID, and the key arrives by e-mail.
- **Activate**: paste the key (Pro keys start `MBUSP-`, Standard `MBUS-`, Runtime `MBUSR-`) and press **Activate license**. The licence is perpetual for that machine.
- **New computer**: a key is bound to one machine; write to support@modbusmanager.com to move it.
- Updates are free for 12 months from purchase; see the licence terms.

LANGUAGES

The interface is translated into nine languages, chosen from the flag in the toolbar. **Pro**: English, German, Spanish, French, Portuguese, Ukrainian, Chinese, Polish and Estonian. **Standard**: the same with

Russian in place of Ukrainian. A restart applies the choice everywhere.

TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	CHECK
No reply from a TCP device	IP and port (502), that the PC reaches the network (ping), the unit ID, and whether another master is holding the device's only connection.
RTU: timeouts	COM port, baud, parity, data and stop bits; A/B polarity of RS-485; termination on long lines; the slave ID. Try **Auto-detect**.
Exception 02 (illegal address)	Address base (0 or 1), function code (FC03 vs FC04), and that the block does not run past the device's map — read fewer registers.
32-bit values look absurd	Word order: right-click the 32-bit cell and try the four orders, or set *Low word first* on the tag.
A dashboard element shows "—" or is dimmed	Polling is stopped, the source is wrong, or the value stopped arriving. Hover it for the last update; check the binding in Properties.
A write does nothing	The dashboard must be in **Runtime**, and the element must have read a value first. Input registers and discrete inputs cannot be written.
S7: connection refused or no data	PUT/GET permitted, optimized block access off for the DB, rack/slot, and for the S7 server that the PLC's IP is on the allowed list.
Trial expired	Activate a key for your Machine ID in the licence window.

The 🔍 **Diagnose** link and **Auto-detect** (see Scanning) answer most connection questions before a support e-mail. If you write to support, copy the diagnostic text from the licence reminder's *I am stuck* page.

FAQ

How do I connect to a Modbus TCP device?

Press Connect, stay on TCP/IP, enter the IP address and port (502 by default) and connect; then set the slave/unit ID in the poll window and press Start.

Which function codes are supported?

Reading: FC01, FC02, FC03, FC04. Writing: FC05, FC06, FC15, FC16, FC22 and FC23. The Test Center also

sends FC08 diagnostics, FC11, FC17 and FC43/14 device identification.

What is the difference between address base 0 and base 1?

Base 0 uses protocol addresses (first register = 0); Base 1 uses documentation addresses (first register = 1). Pick the one your device manual uses.

Can I test without hardware?

Yes. The Slave tab simulates one or more devices over TCP or RTU, with counters, sine waves, ramps, random values and a simulated PID process.

What is the difference between Standard and Pro?

Standard ($49) is the master/slave test tool. Pro ($119) adds the HMI dashboard, tags and Structured Text, Historian, alarms, gateway, Siemens S7 and Runtime packages.

Is there a free trial?

Yes, 14 days with every feature and no credit card. After that you activate a key issued for your machine.

Windows shows “Windows protected your PC” when I run the installer — is that a problem?

No. The installer is code-signed, but SmartScreen shows this notice for releases it has not seen many times yet. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Every release is published on our GitHub releases page, so you can check the download comes from the official source.
